10. INCOME TAXES

Following is an analysis of the components of consolidated income tax expense (benefit):

(In thousands)	2003	2002	2001
Current—			
U.S.	$ (282)	$ (7,526)	$ 17,467
State and local	(32)	1,298	3,700
Total current provision (benefit) for taxes	(314)	(6,228)	21,167
Deferred—			
U.S.	(9,224)	32,159	40,793
State and local	(978)	3,504	5,561
Total deferred provision for taxes	(10,202)	35,663	46,354
Total provision (benefit) for taxes	$ (10,516)	$ 29,435	$67,521

The effective tax rate varies from the U.S. Federal statutory tax rate principally due to the following:

(In thousands)	2003	2002	2001
Provision computed at U.S. Federal statutory rate of 35%	$ (8,711)	$ 27,165	$ 61,053
State and local taxes, net of federal benefit	(1,018)	3,221	7,297
Other	(787)	(951)	(829)
Total	$ (10,516)	$ 29,435	$67,521

10. INCOME TAXES (Continued)

The components of the deferred tax assets (liabilities) were as follows:

(In thousands)	December 31, 2003	2002
Current deferred taxes—		
Accrued liabilities	$ 8,610	$ 2,444
Employee benefits and compensation	8,744	8,467
Reserve for doubtful accounts	2,796	3,056
Inventory	5,401	3,669
Pensions and postretirement benefits	4,152	1,748
Total current deferred taxes	$ 29,703	$ 19,384
Noncurrent deferred taxes—		
Pension and postretirement benefits	$ 2,827	$ 2,053
Excess of financial reporting over tax basis in plant and equipment	(287,574)	(254,659)
Accrued liabilities	(5,961)	2,013
Asset for alternative minimum tax credits	16,796	8,664
Derivatives	(147)	557
Net operating loss carryforwards	43,110	—
Total noncurrent deferred taxes	$ (230,949)	$ (241,372)

Cash payments for income taxes were $0.9 million, $1.2 million and $23.4 million for the years ended December 31, 2003, 2002 and 2001, respectively. As of December 31, 2003 and 2002, the Company had available for income tax purposes approximately $16.8 million and $8.7 million, respectively, in alternative minimum tax credits which may be used to offset future taxable income. As of December 31, 2003, the Company had available approximately $100.2 million in net operating loss carryforwards which will expire in 2023.